

Migraines

A severe or moderate headache, usually on one side of the head, sometimes with warning signs beforehand like visual disturbances; occasionally, no headache but other symptoms

Complications: Sometimes vomiting, nausea

Causes: Unknown, may be due to abnormal nerve signals affecting chemicals and blood vessels in the brain

Symptoms: Blurred vision, headache, increased sensitivity to light and sound, vomiting, nausea

Diagnosis: Clinical diagnosis, pattern of symptoms

Treatment: Migraine medication, painkillers, rest

Tips for prevention: Avoiding or reducing known triggers, taking preventative medications



Mumps

A contagious viral infection that causes painful swellings at the side of the face under the ears

Complications: Damage to pancreas, infertility (rarely), meningitis, swollen ovaries or testicles

Causes: Viral infection, spread through saliva

Symptoms: Fever, headache, joint pain, swelling of parotid salivary glands on face under ears

Diagnosis: Saliva swab

Treatment: Cold compress for swollen glands, fluids, mild painkillers, rest; infection usually resolves itself within 2 weeks

Tips for prevention: Vaccination



Sexually transmitted diseases (STDs)

A variety of bacterial, parasitic, and viral infections

Complications: Fertility issues, skin problems, neurological damage

Causes: Bacteria, viruses, parasites

Symptoms: Sometimes none; sometimes changes to menstrual bleeding, genital discharge, itching, rashes, urinary and bowel problems

Diagnosis: Blood tests, genital swabs, urine tests

Treatment: Dependent on infection; antibiotic, antiviral, or antiparasitic medication, currently no cure for HIV but

medications can help a person live a long, healthy life

Tips for prevention: Regular STD checks, ask sexual partners if they've had an STD check, practice safer sex



Urinary tract infections (UTIs)

Bacterial infection of the bladder, called cystitis

Complications: Kidney damage with recurrent UTIs

Causes: Bacterial infection

Symptoms: Blood in urine, painful and/or frequent urination, smelly urine

Diagnosis: Urine sample

Treatment: Antibiotics, fluids, rest

Tips for prevention: Staying hydrated, females should wipe from front to back after going to the toilet



Vaccinations

Infectious agents such as bacteria and viruses are called pathogens. Vaccinations help the human body fight infections by exposing it to a harmless version of a particular pathogen. This triggers the immune system to produce the antibodies needed to fight that pathogen should it be encountered in the future. Vaccination programs help to prevent and reduce infection from many deadly diseases.

GOOD TO KNOW

Recommended vaccinations

A number of vaccinations and booster shots need to be given to teens between the ages of 11 and 18. It's important for every teen to have a record of the shots that they've received, and to keep it updated. Booster shots are just as important as the initial immunization and should be administered at the right time to maintain immunity.